

# RepoSkins Free Kit — Setup Guide

Animated profile cards · Snake Trail · social badges. Self-hosted, no shared backend, no signup.

## Read this first.

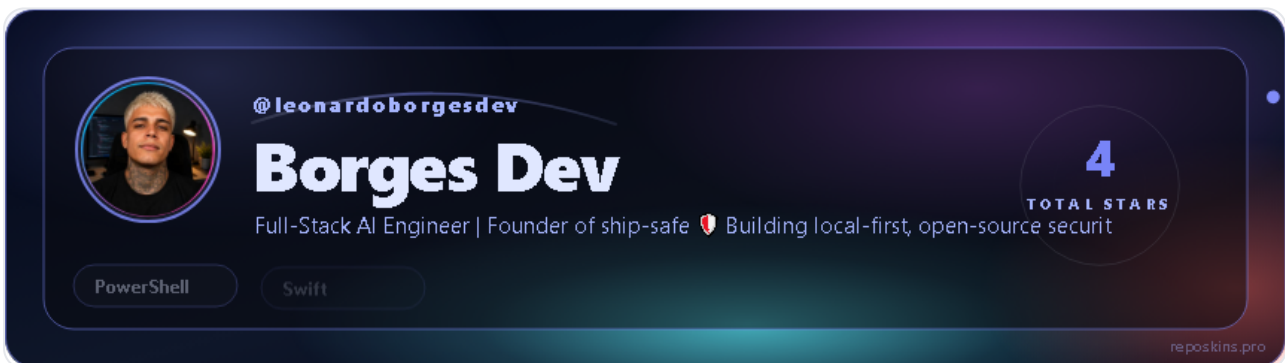
This kit runs entirely on your machine. It calls two services and nothing else: `api.github.com` for your own data (with your own token) and `img.shields.io` to build badge images — no GitHub Actions, no separate branch to babysit. It never calls `reposkins.pro` or `gitskins.com`. Two people running this against the same username get the exact same cards — this isn't generative, it's a template engine, and that's the point: it's meant to be predictable and inspectable.

## You need:

Python 3.10+, a GitHub account, and the `gh` CLI (or a classic Personal Access Token, `repo` scope). Budget 10 minutes.

## What you get

- **2 free themes** — `midnight` and `github-dark`, both fully themed across every card below
- **8 cards** — hero, wordmark, heatmap, portrait, chess, system-scan, highlights, social-row
- **Bonus card** — **Snake Trail** — an animated contribution grid with a real snake trail, `midnight` theme only
- **Social badges** — shields.io, zero API calls



Real output — @leonardoborgesdev, theme `midnight`. Nothing here is a mockup.

## PHASE 1 — Generate the cards

Clone the kit and install the two dependencies ( `requests` , `Pillow` ):

```
git clone https://github.com/leonardoborgesdev/reposkins.git
cd reposkins
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

Authenticate and export a token — without this the heatmap and Snake Trail cards come back with an empty contribution graph (the calendar query needs one) and you'll hit the public API's 60-requests/hour limit fast:

```
export GITHUB_TOKEN=$(gh auth token)
```

Then generate:

```
python generate.py YOUR_USERNAME --theme midnight \
  --cards hero,wordmark,heatmap,portrait,chess,system-scan,highlights,social-row,snake-trail
```

This writes SVGs to `assets/` and a ready `README.generated.md` . Every card is a static file — nothing to schedule, nothing that needs to keep running after this command finishes.





chosen theme — every other logo (Instagram, Gmail, Facebook) recolors fine.

## What to expect

| Phase            | Effort | Iteration?                                                                   |
|------------------|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 — Cards        | 5 min  | Maybe — re-run with a different <code>--cards</code> or <code>--theme</code> |
| 2 — Special repo | 2 min  | No, but easy to get wrong once                                               |
| 3 — Badges       | 2 min  | No — config only                                                             |

## Troubleshooting

| Symptom                                                                    | Cause                                                           | Fix                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Heatmap or Snake Trail card is empty                                       | No <code>GITHUB_TOKEN</code> set                                | <code>export GITHUB_TOKEN=\$(gh auth token)</code> before running          |
| <code>rate limit exceeded</code>                                           | Unauthenticated public API, 60 req/hour                         | Same fix as above                                                          |
| Special profile view never shows up                                        | Repo created via API                                            | Recreate via the <b>web UI</b> , exact name <code>username/username</code> |
| Image doesn't update on the profile                                        | GitHub's camo cache                                             | Append <code>?v=2</code> , <code>?v=3</code> ... to the image URL          |
| Snake Trail looks like midnight even with <code>--theme github-dark</code> | Only a real <code>midnight</code> template exists for this card | Expected — request <code>--theme midnight</code> if you want it to match   |

## What's intentionally not in the free kit

`about` , `stats` , and `stack` cards aren't included — today they only render pixel-perfect in the `midnight` theme even in the hosted product, and shipping a mis-themed card for free felt worse than not shipping it. The other 19 themes and full customization live at [reposkins.pro](https://reposkins.pro) for anyone who'd rather not run anything locally.

— END OF SETUP GUIDE —